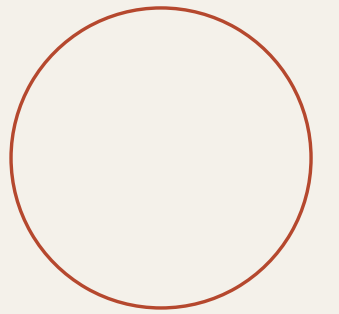




Education *Policy*

Week 1 — Introduction & policies

PART ONE

Course info & policies

What the course is and how it runs.

THE BASICS

Course at a glance

COURSE CODE

PUBP309

CREDITS

3

PROGRAM

Undergraduate

A one-semester introduction to education policy in India.

PART TWO

Understanding education

From the learner outward — reading the system from micro to macro.

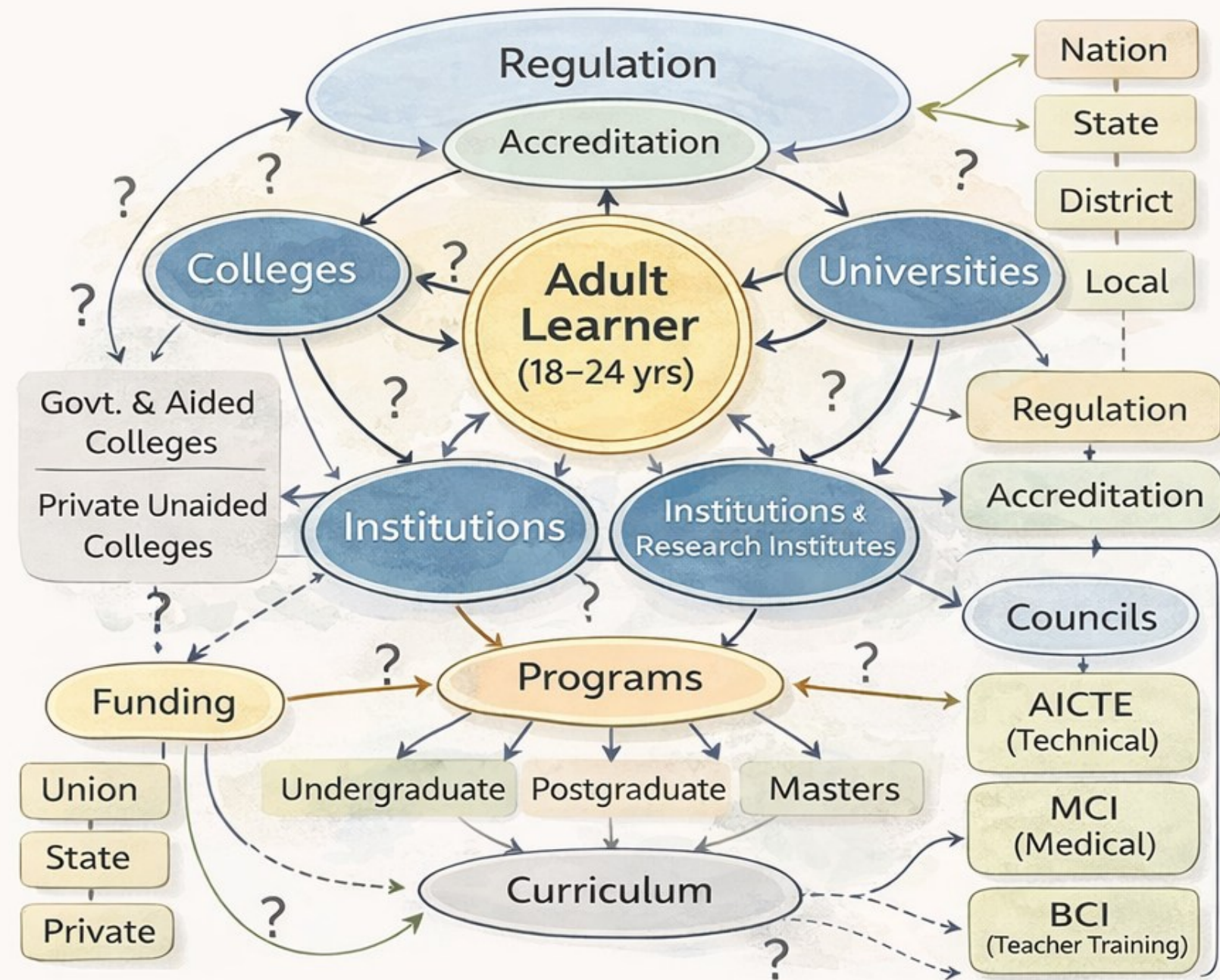
Who shapes a school *learner*?

A K-12 child sits inside widening circles — home and siblings, peers, teachers, community, and the social structure of caste, gender and religion.



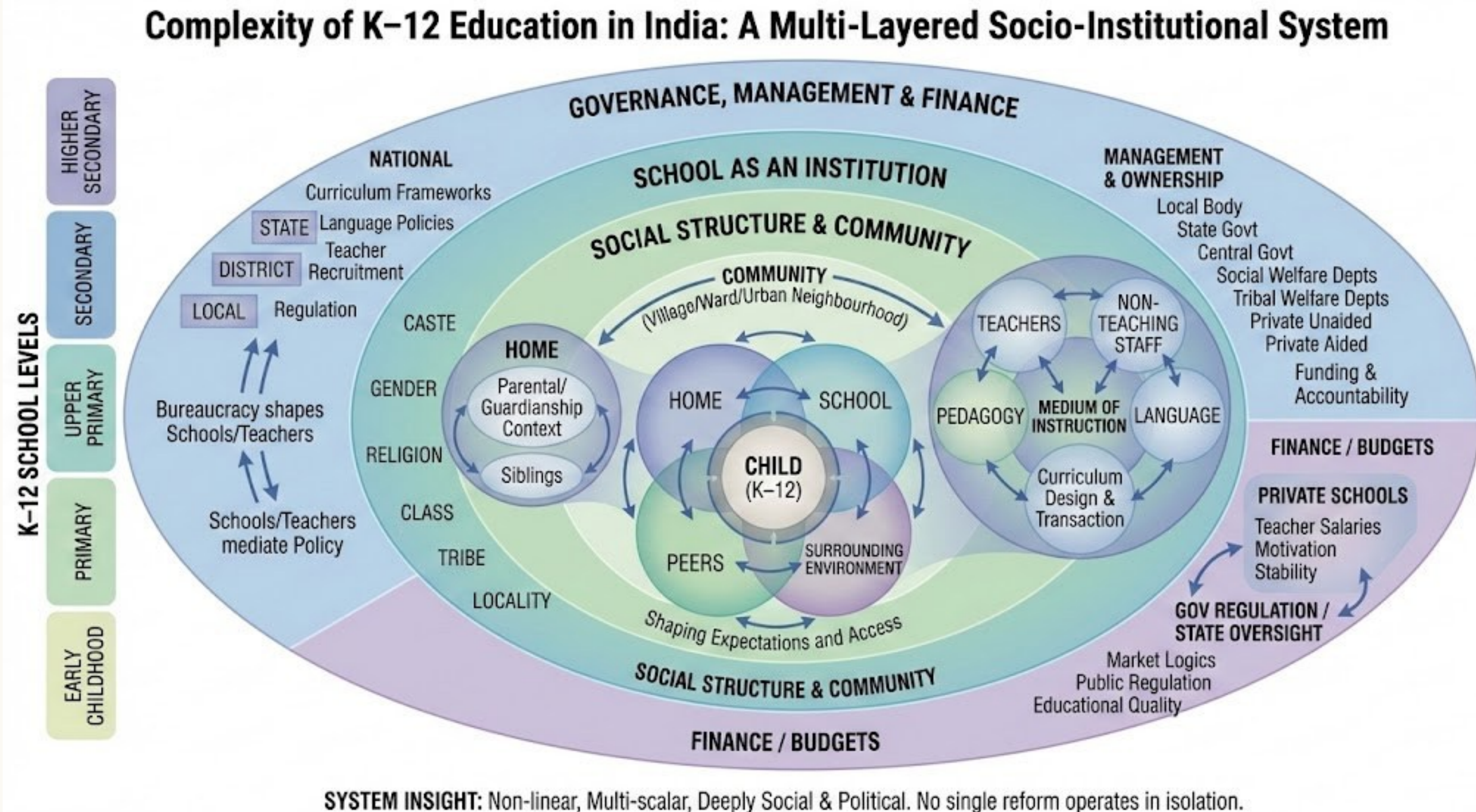
Who shapes an adult *learner*?

In higher education the circles change — colleges and universities, programs and curricula, funding from union, state and private sources, all under regulation and accreditation.



The complexity of school education

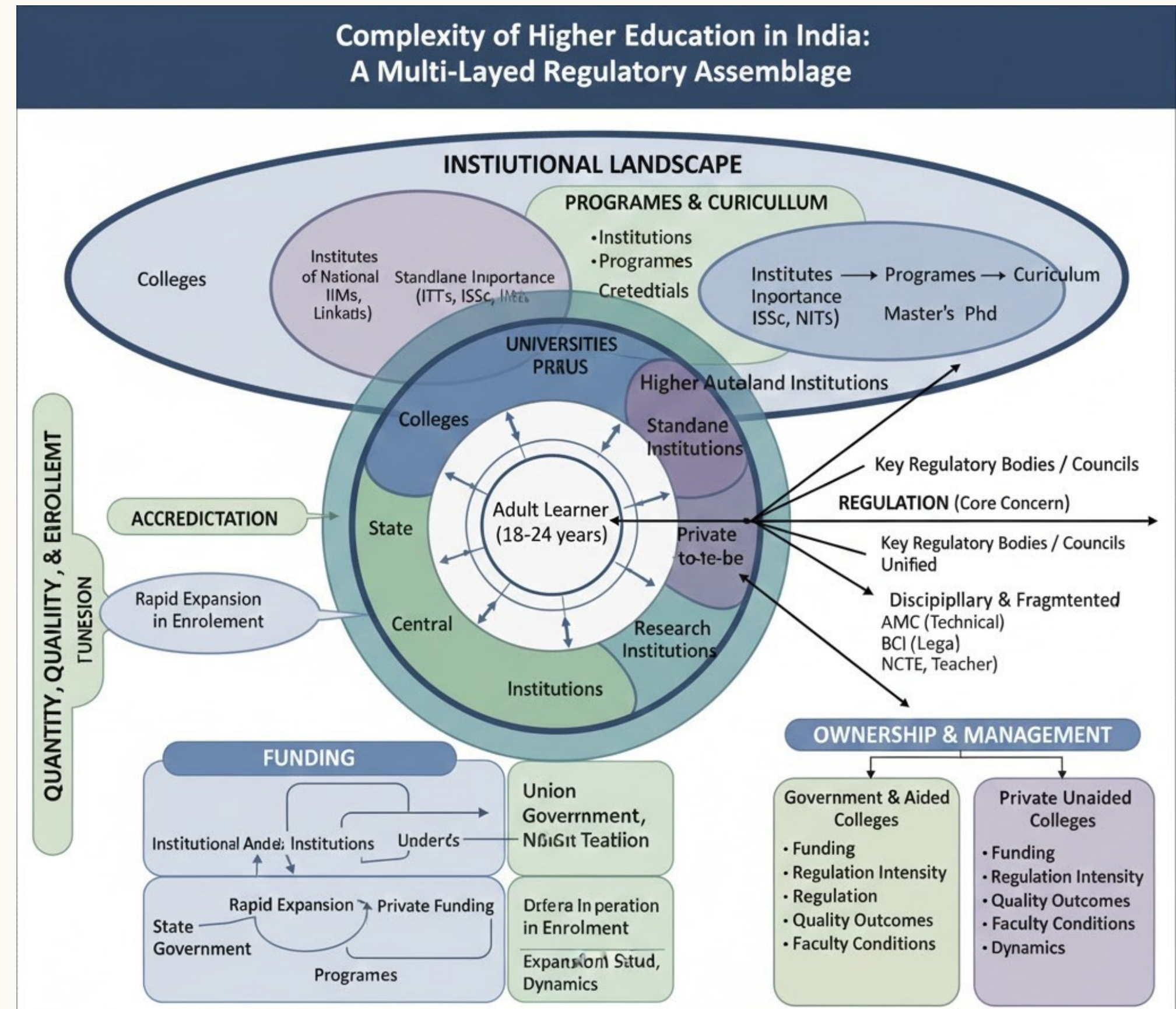
*Non-linear, multi-scalar, deeply social & political
— no single reform works alone.*



A REGULATORY ASSEMBLAGE

The complexity of higher *education*

Quantity, quality and enrolment pull against a fragmented field of regulators, councils, funders and owners — public, aided and private.

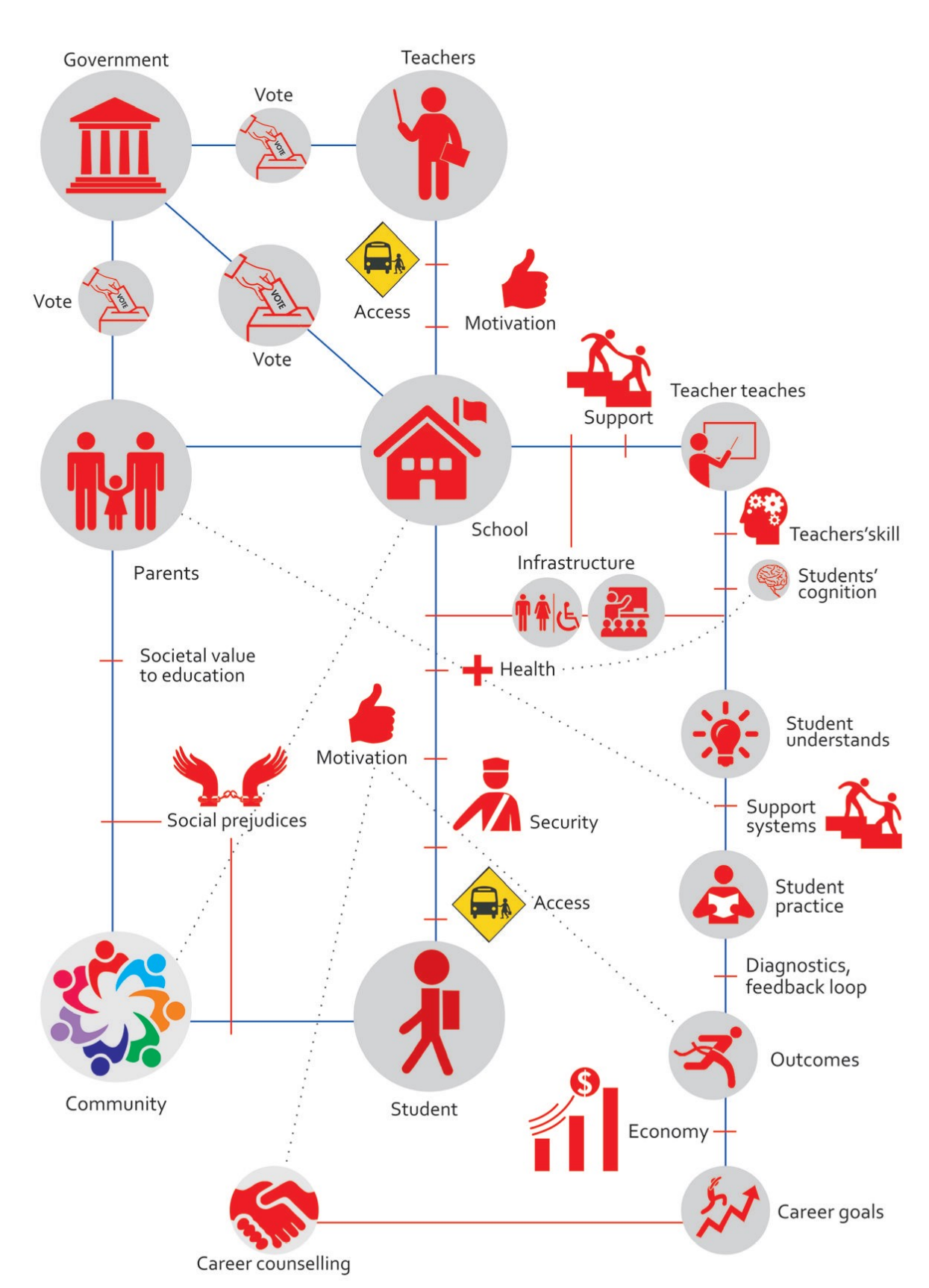


Regulation is the core concern.

POLICY → OUTCOME

The black box of *reform*

Between a policy and a result sits a long chain — government, parents, community, school, teachers and students, tied together by access, motivation, support and feedback. Reform succeeds or fails inside this box.



LISTEN & DISCUSS

What does *education* mean?

“Quality has to do a lot with the meaning of education.”

DR. VIMALA RAMACHANDRAN

ColabCast · Season 1, Episode 1 — *play 3:00-7:30*

open.spotify.com/episode/2BxsryLSSsSkI09jDYPFAFQ



PART THREE

Scope, topics & readings

Where the semester goes.

What you will be able to do

01 Trace how India's education system and policies evolved across colonial and post-colonial India.

03 Understand the growth and challenges of higher education in India.

02 Critically examine challenges in elementary and secondary education — and the policy instruments used to address them.

04 Evaluate an education-policy proposal or instrument in its appropriate context.

Indian Education System and History

1.1 School system in India 10 HRS

Current structure & comparative schooling — India, China, USA, Japan
History: indigenous, colonial & missionary schools; thinkers of modern education
Modern India: UEE, Right to Education, Kothari Commission & NPE
Growth of private schools & school management

1.3 Higher education system 8 HRS

Current structure & comparative analysis across the world
Colonial roots: Wood's Dispatch, the 1858 universities, University Acts
UGC and the expansion of colleges & universities
Private universities & institutions of national importance

1.2 History of Schooling in India

- i) Indigenous Education and Schools
- ii) Education in Colonial India: Missionary Schools, British Schools, and Grant in Aid Schools; Thinkers of Modern Education
- iii) Major Education Policies in Colonial India; Schools and School Management in Colonial India
- iv) National Education System

Preceded by a 2-hour introduction — layers, levels and determinants of learning.

Education bureaucracy & finance

Education in the Constitution

Constituent Assembly debates
Union, State & Concurrent lists
RTE, child labour, language & minority institutions

School education governance

Bureaucracy at national, state & local level
Decentralisation & RTE
Teacher education & state capacity

Higher education governance

UGC, regulatory bodies & councils
State & private university acts
Commissions & NEP in higher education

Curriculum, pedagogy & learning

Language & medium of instruction — the mother-tongue debate
The crisis of learning — foundational literacy & numeracy
Social barriers — caste, class, gender & disability

Interventions & reforms

Access & retention — midday meals, cycles, cash transfers
Learning — Teaching at the Right Level, activity-based & adaptive learning
Structure & choice — school complexes, vouchers, RTE 12(1)(c)

Policy questions we will examine

Access & equity in elementary education

Gender & education

Universalization of elementary education

Education outcomes & the learning-level crisis

Public spending on education

Privatization of education

Higher education — expansion, access, quality & regulation

...read comparatively, evaluated as proposals.

What to read

- Sarangapani, P. M., & Pappu, R. (Eds.). (2021). *Handbook of Education Systems in South Asia* (Selected chapters). Springer.
- Naik, J. P., & Nurullah, S. (1974). *Students' History of Education in India, 1800-1973*. Macmillan.
- Ghosh, S. C. (2009). *The History of Education in Modern India, 1757-2007*. Orient BlackSwan.
- Indian Education Commission (Kothari Commission report) (1964-1966). *Education and National Development (Kothari Commission Report)*. Government of India.
- Mangla, A. (2022). *Making Bureaucracy Work: Norms, Education, and Public Service Delivery in Rural India*. Cambridge University Press.
- Government of India. (1986). *National Policy on Education 1986*. Ministry of Human Resource Development, Government of India.
- Government of India. (1992). *Programme of Action 1992 (to the National Policy on Education, 1986)*. Ministry of Human Resource Development, Government of India.
- Government of India (2019), *Draft National Education Policy (2019)*. Government of India.
- Muralidharan, K. (2024). *Accelerating India's development: A state-led roadmap for effective governance*. Penguin Random House India. ISBN 978-0670095940.
- Ayyar, R.V. Vaidyanatha, *History of Education Policymaking in India, 1947 2016* (Delhi, 2017; online edn, Oxford Academic, 19 Apr. 2018,
- **Reports, Research Articles, Policy briefs...**

Plus NPE 1986, NEP drafts, and selected reports, research articles & policy briefs.

What to read

- **Indian Education Commission (1964-1966) Report**
- Kingdon, G. G. (2007). **The progress of school education in India**. Oxford Review of Economic Policy, 23(2), 168-195.
- (selected chapters) Mondal, Arijit (2015), **The Universalization of elementary education in India : A historical analysis**.
- (Articles on Education)Drèze, J. (2017). **Sense and Solidarity: Jholawala Economics for Everyone**. Permanent Black.
- (Chapter 4) Banerjee, A. V., Banerjee, A., & Duflo, E. (2011). **Poor economics: A radical rethinking of the way to fight global poverty**. Public Affairs.
- **Reports, Research Articles, Policy briefs...**